

The Will & The Fox





Game Concept:

- **The Will & The Fox** is an asymmetric local-multiplayer experience that redefines the "chase" genre through supernatural mechanics and environmental volatility.
- Players are trapped in a shifting architectural nightmare where the terrain is just as dangerous as the opponent.
- **Dynamic Parkour:** Movement is the primary interaction.
- **Atmospheric Horror:** Gothic-inspired visual style.
- **Strategic Avoidance:** No direct combat; victory is earned through agility.

Design Foundations



Cooperative Roots

Inspired by *Fireboy & Watergirl*, focusing on single-keyboard local multiplayer and shared-screen tension.



Mechanical Precision

Utilizing the tight movement and upgrade progression found in titles like *Hollow Knight*.



Gothic Ambience

Architecture inspired by the Wills Memorial Building, providing a vertical, labyrinthine stage.

The Wills Memorial

- The arena is more than a backdrop; it is a sentient participant. The Gothic architecture of the university's landmark is reimagined as a shifting, spectral prison.
- As the "Will" of the building changes, structural collapses create new pathways and dead ends in real-time.



Player I: The Spectral Fox



Role: The Aggressor

The Fox is defined by speed, momentum, and predatory tracking. Its goal is to exhaust the prey through relentless pursuit.

Unique Traits:

- Infinite dash with a cooldown.
- Scent trails showing the Ghost's recent path.
- Wall-run ability for superior verticality.

Player II: The Ghost of Will

Role: The Survivalist

Will represents the strategic player. Survival depends on manipulating the architecture and using phasing abilities to evade capture.

Unique Traits:

- Intangibility: Phase through specific walls.
- Static Shifting: Cause a platform to crumble.
- Shadow Clone: Decoy spirits to confuse the Fox.



Mechanical Twists



Zero Damage

Combat is entirely avoided. Players cannot attack; the conflict is won through out-maneuvering and trapping.



Shifting Maze

The floor plan changes every 30 seconds, forcing players to memorize patterns and adapt instantly.



Verticality

Focus on climbing. Falling to the bottom floor resets progress or results in immediate capture.



Evolutionary Progression

- As the match progresses, both characters gain "Spectral Essence" from the environment, allowing for mid-game upgrades.
- **Ethereal Dash:** Increased travel distance.
- **Kinetic Sight:** Predictive movement markers.
- **Gravity Well:** Momentarily slow down the opponent.